nearby laundry shop when she was stopped by some men and told to accompany them to Jaya Nagar police station.

Until that morning of Mridula's confession, the Bangalore Police were not even sure if the most-wanted Sivarasan was hiding in their city. And here they were, hearing Sivarasan's story from someone who, till one day back, had shared a house with him and his gang of assassins. The commissioner of police asked Mridula if she could show them the house. Mridula said yes, provided the police gave her protection. The DCP Crime, an ACP and a female constable accompanied her in a private car to Konankunte.[5]

Again, the Bangalore Police had not yet informed the tracking team about Mridula being in their custody. The matter reached the SIT's ears through some friends in the IB. Sri Kumar and Verma rushed to the Jaya Nagar police station, where they were given second-hand information, since Mridula was not there. The SIT had lost Rangan's track in Trichy, but it had learnt from the police that according to Mridula, Rangan was in Bangalore and had been driving them around in a green Maruti Gypsy. The tracking team realized they would have to move on their own. Waiting for the local police to be proactive was wishful thinking. Verma and Ragothaman wanted to take up the matter of 'non-cooperation of the Bangalore Police' with the higher authorities but was placated by Sri Kumar. Rubbing a single officer in the Bangalore Police the wrong way could be catastrophic at this point in their investigation.

Accompanying the DCP Crime in a private car, Mridula explained that the front of the Konanakunte house faced the rear area of a neighbour's house, separated by a few yards. From one of the bathrooms of the neighbour's house, one could peep into the Konanakunte house and watch the movements of the assassin gang. The DCP, by then, had mounted a watch on the Konanakunte house from the neighbour's bathroom. He had also brought a few men and officers for assistance. Their vehicles were parked on the road, behind the neighbour's house, hidden from view by a row of houses. From inside the hideout, these vehicles could not be seen. But anyone coming to the hideout could clearly see the vehicles. And that's